



FOUNDERSFORGE

Revenue Strategy & Growth Playbook

Net Impact Consulting
April 2026



Agenda

01. Current Situation & Key Challenges

02. Core Solution & Strategy

03. Execution Plan

04. Strategic Opportunities

05. Expected Impact & Next Steps



FoundersForge Operates From a Position of Strength But Faces Structural Challenges

Strengths

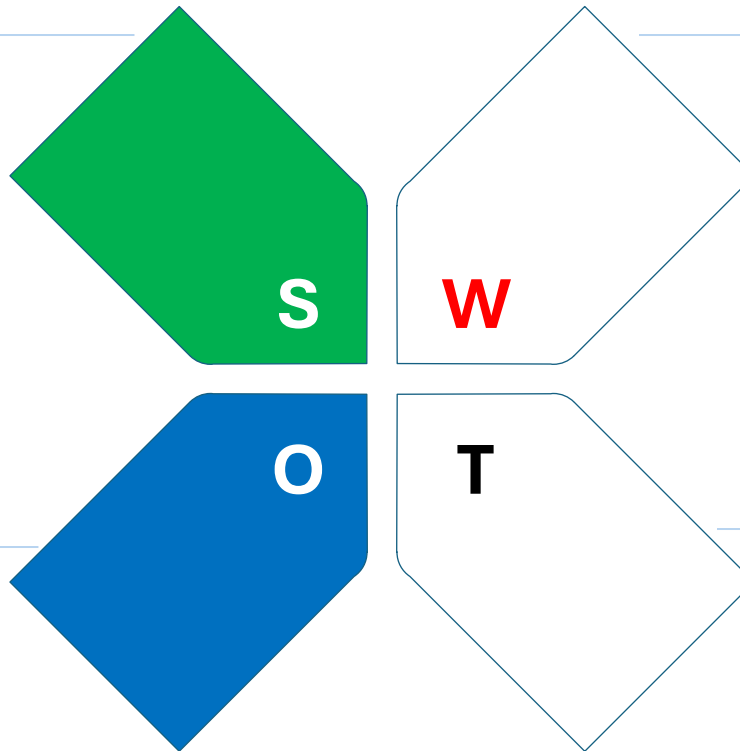
Lean, Scalable Operating Model

- Avante: proprietary, asset-light, national
- Startup Mountain Summit: growing flagship event
- AI bootcamp: new revenue stream (\$1,500/seat)

Opportunities

Clear paths to scale revenue

- Launch TN partnership: ~\$250K/year
- Alumni pipeline (e.g., Green Lama)
- Naming rights / HNWI sponsorship



Weaknesses

Capacity and Structural Gap

- 3-person team (1 on leave)
- No structured sponsorship tiers outreach system
- Early-stage ecosystem limits near-term funding

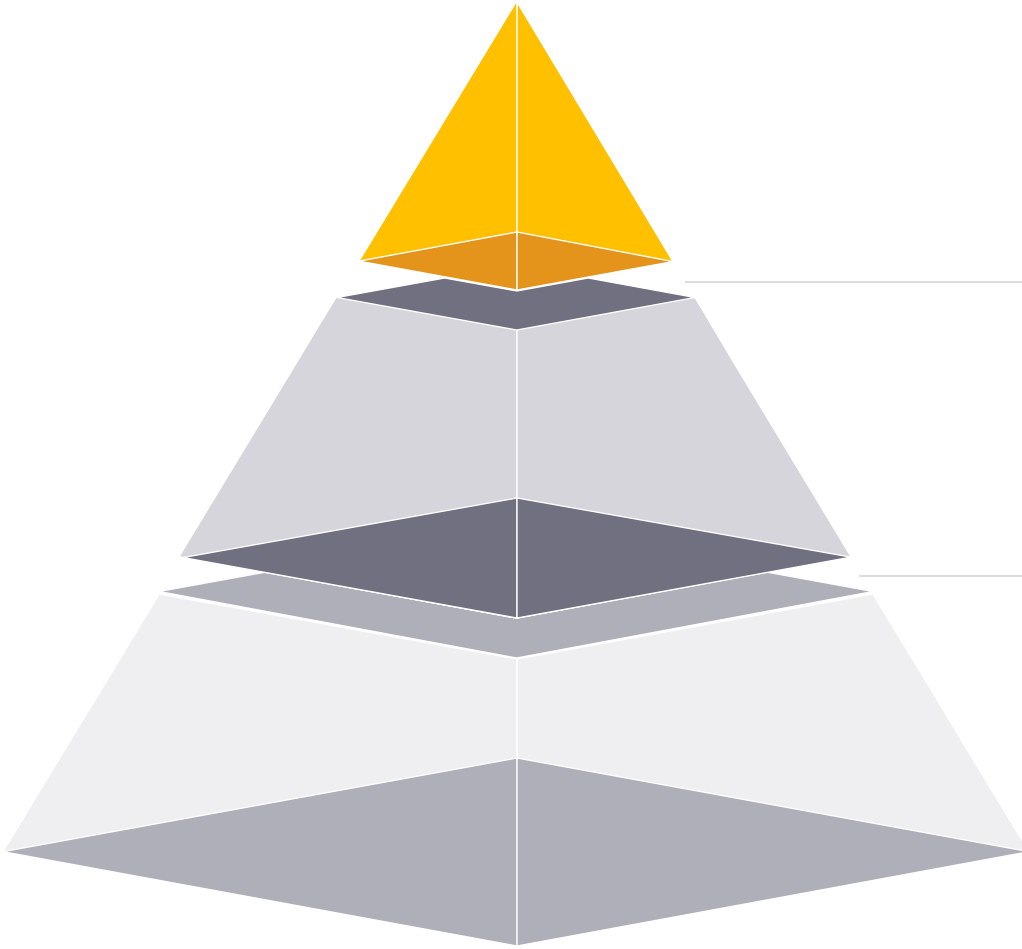
Threats

External and structural risks

- ETSU Research Corp (better funded)
- Grant dependency -> mission drift
- Ecosystem maturity (20-years horizon)
- Team burnout from limited capacity



Capacity Constraints and Lack of Structure are Limiting FoundersForge's Revenue Growth



Revenue

Significant revenue opportunities go unrealized due to inefficiencies
Existing programs, sponsors, and leads are not consistently converted into revenue.

Organizational Challenges

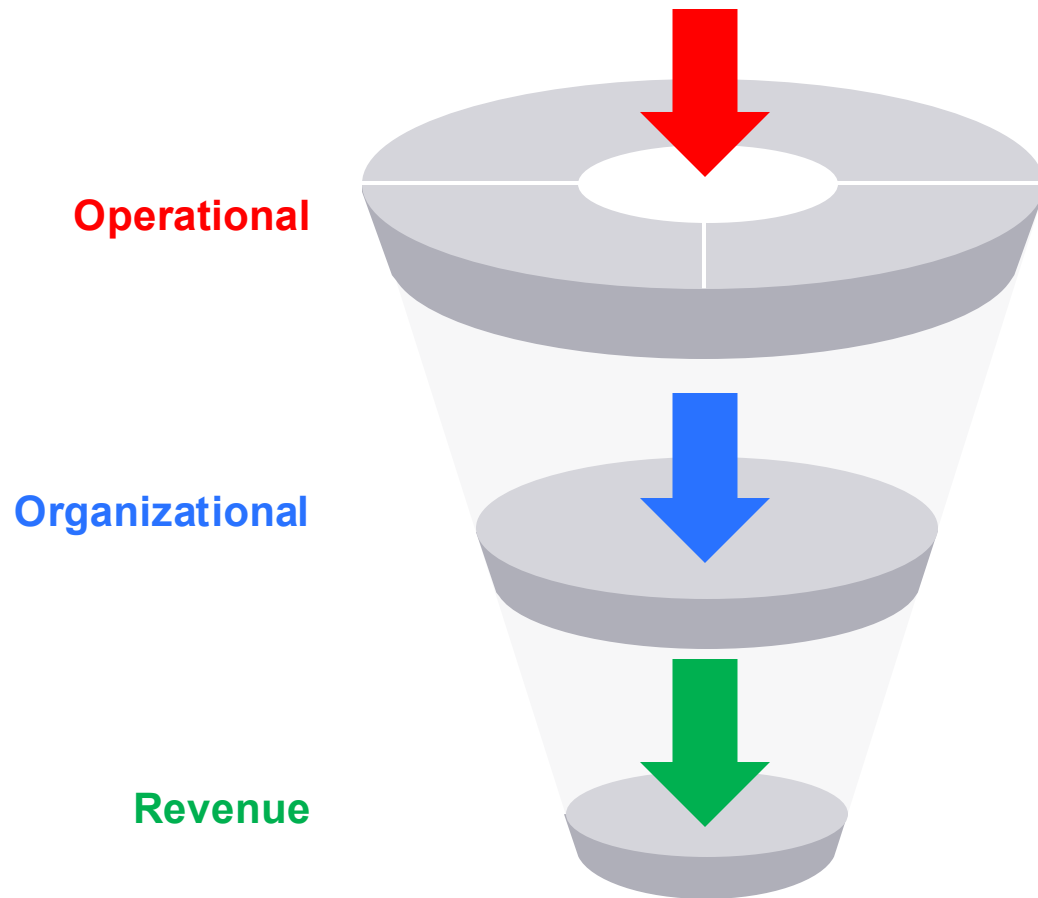
Unstructured outreach and Monetization process
Sponsorships, partnerships, and donor efforts are ad hoc and not systemized.

Operational Root Cause

Severe Capacity Constraints Limit Execution
3-person team managing multiple functions creates inefficiency and limits growth



Structured Outreach Powered by Operational Efficiency Builds Effective Revenue Engine



Hire Subsidized Intern via Launch Tennessee

An additional outreach-focused intern would ease the workload of full-time employees, freeing them to concentrate on innovation and program growth without disrupting the \$177,000 budget

Establish Outreach Program

Establishing a formal outreach program and delegating outreach responsibilities to a dedicated intern would reduce role overlap and bring organizational clarity

Utilize Outreach capabilities to generate revenue

Leverage structured outreach capabilities to execute the Avante Partnership Framework while delivering defined, targeted asks to high-net-worth individuals



The Outreach Intern: Building and Sustaining High-Value Relationships

Ideal Profile

Excellent Proven Interpersonal Skills

- Background in Business/sales and/or Communications
- Proven ability to effectively communicate within vetting process
- Strong academic profile and reputation of trustworthiness
- Experience Navigating CRM Platforms

Logistic Fit

- Available via launch Tennessee or other subsidized internship programs
- Able to maintain a minimum of 25 hours per week



Primary Responsibilities

Sales For Avante Partnership Framework

- Identify and research businesses well-suited for the Avante Partnership Framework
- Execute outreach and sales tasks for employer-approved business targets

Assisting With Maintaining and Fulfilling Avante Partnership Requests

- Identify and communicate client needs and requests to the appropriate chain of command
- Assist with developing sponsorship products
- Develop and Maintain Basic CRM as needed (HubSpot CRM)



Avante Partnership Framework (APF): A Scalable Revenue Model Built on Existing Program Infrastructure

Built On Existing Infrastructure

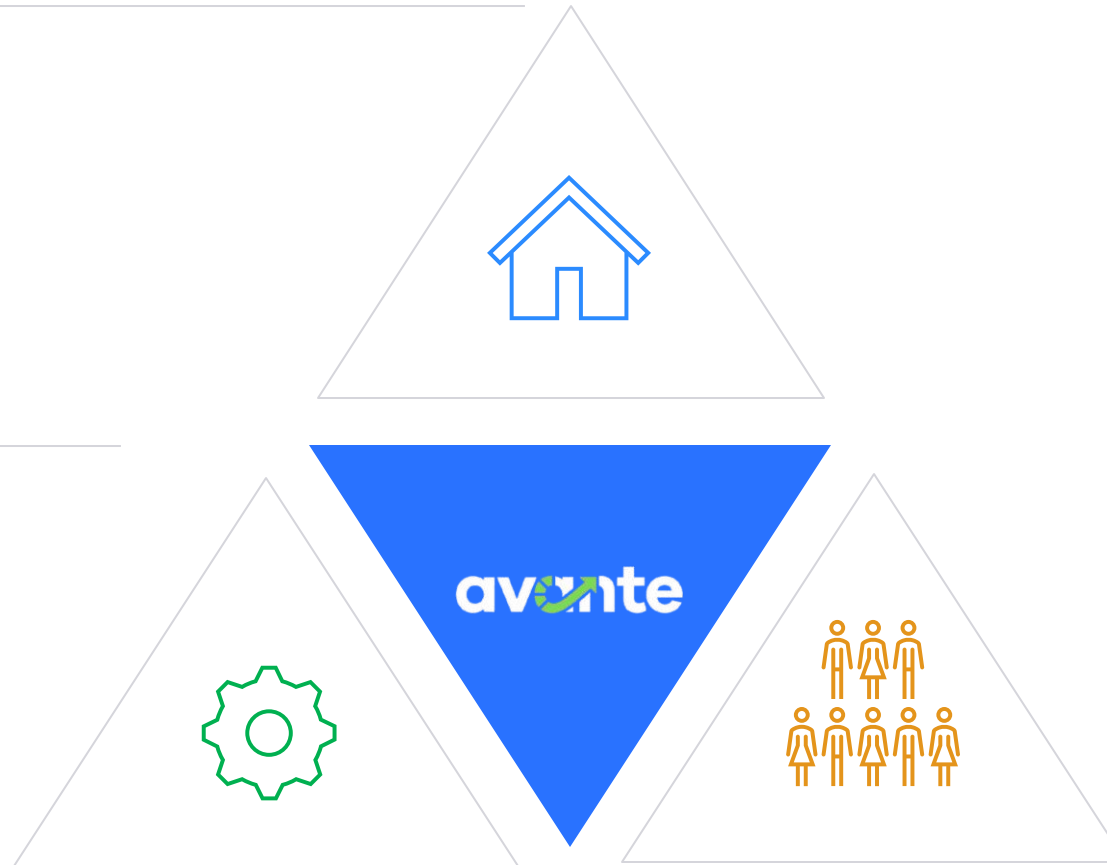
The Avante Partnership framework is built on top of six module curriculum, providing additional value to businesses

- Minimal program modification to onboard sponsors
- Leverages Avante and FoundersForge Network

Customizable Value

FoundersForge's lean team structure enables a uniquely agile model, allowing sponsors to receive customizable, scalable partnership

- Sponsors can fund specific modules aligned to their industry
- Small organizational footprint allows for flexible accommodating asks
- Flexible tiers accommodate all businesses



Catalyst for Connection

APF expands FoundersForge ecosystem, connecting businesses to their target market

- Customer Model creates recurring engagement opportunities
- Connects B2B businesses directly to their target market through program participants
- Builds long-term relationships between sponsors and the Appalachian startup ecosystem



Avante Partnership Framework (APF)

Self-Sustaining and Efficient

Key partners  • Chambers Of Commerce and other economic development organizations (front-end customer base) • High Net Worth Individuals (startup and operating cost resource) • Launch Tennessee (workforce resource) • APF Sponsors (Back-end customer base)	Key activities  • Curriculum Delivery through Licensed Partners • Sponsor Outreach And Relationship Management • Sponsored Content Development Key resources  • Proprietary Avante Curriculum • Founders Forge Team and outreach program • Existing Partner Network	Value propositions  • Customizable and scalable Embedded Branded Sponsorships • Direct Access to FoundersForge Ecosystem (Networking Opportunities) • Direct Access to Target Market in the form of Direct Early-Stage founders	Ideal Customer relationships  • Long-Term recurring partnerships • Relationship Managed by Outreach Intern • High Trust engagements Channels  • Direct Outreach via Intern • FoundersForge Startup Ecosystem (EX. Startup Mountain Summit) • Avante Network (Successful Avante Alum)	Customer segments  • B2B SaaS and Fintech Companies represent approximately 40% of FoundersForge's current ecosystem • Legal/Financial Service Firms • Businesses Seeking Startup Ecosystem Access
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Overview

- **The Avante Partnership Framework enables FoundersForge to generate external revenue through existing infrastructure** while delivering direct market access to sponsors of any size. From local firms to national brands, all without compromising organizational mission



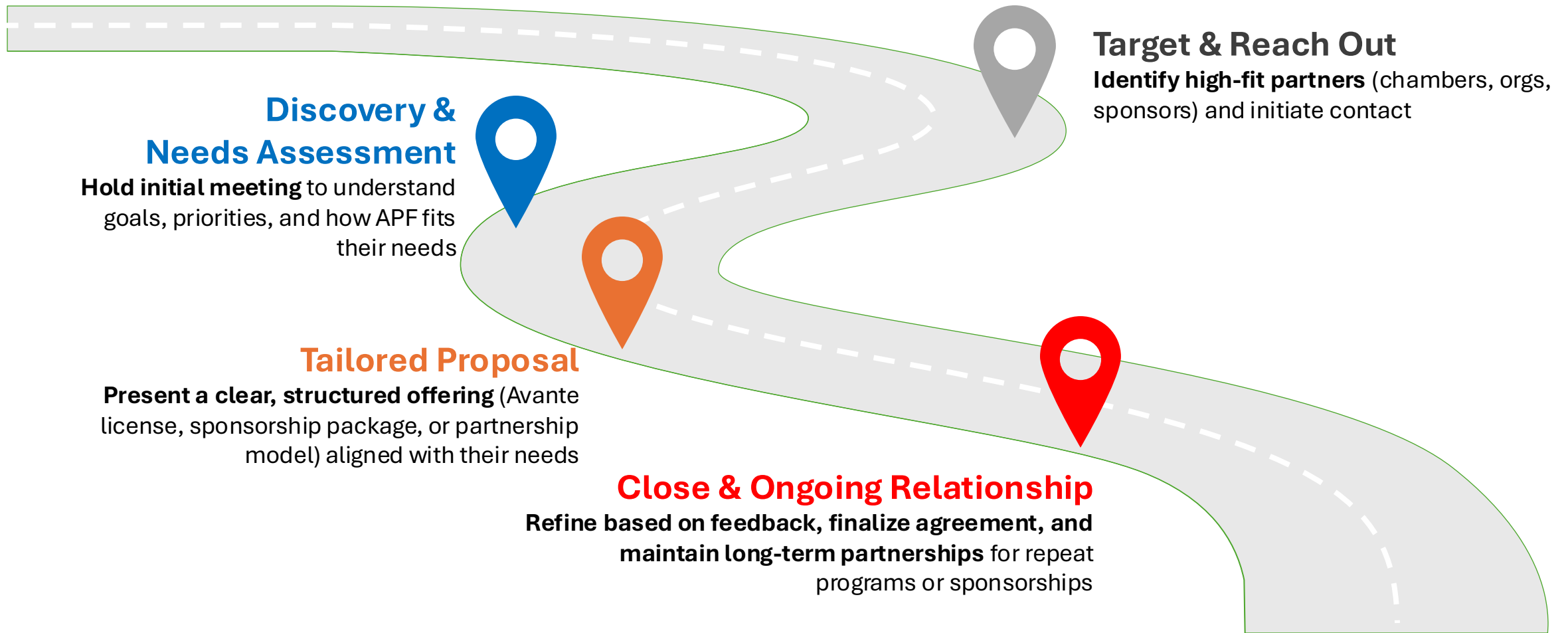
Structured Outreach: Defining Roles to Maximize Efficiency and Revenue Conversion

FoundersForge Swimlane Responsibility Matrix

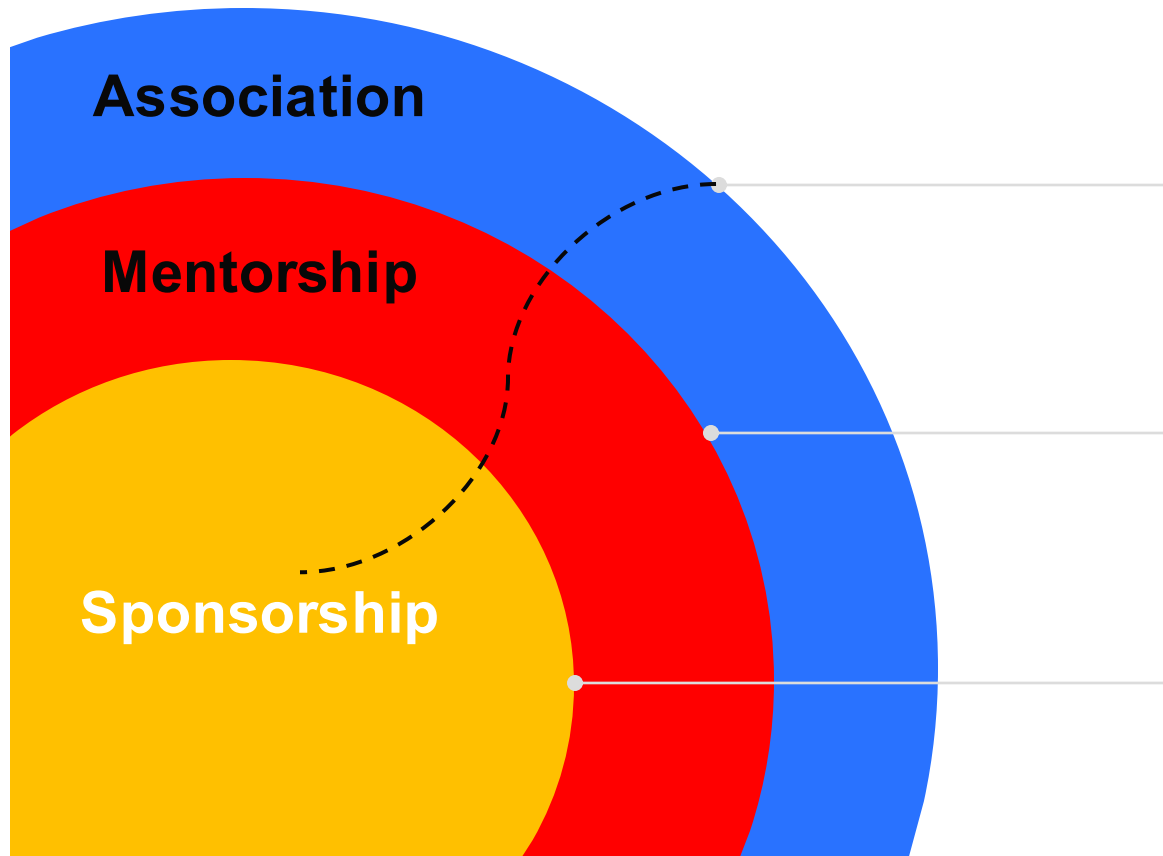
Primary Tasks	Avante Partnership Framework Outreach Tasks (Outreach Intern)			
	Avante Partnership Framework Construction and Proposal (Hybrid)			
	Avante Partnership Framework Relationship Management (Hybrid)			
	High Net Worth Individuals Interactions (Core Employee)			
Support Tasks	Outreach Tasks (Intern) • CRM Creation & management • Initial Contact • Contract Creation • Scripting • Relaying Information to Management	Construction & Proposal (Hybrid) • Provide detailed briefing and Input based on customer request (Intern) • APF Proposal based on Intern Briefing (Core) • Present defined ask (Core) • Deliver Proposal (Core)	Relationship Management (Hybrid) • Continued CRM management (Intern) • Lead all ongoing partner communication and retention conversations (Hybrid) • Identify upsell opportunities (hybrid)	High Net-Worth Individual Interactions (Core) • Lead and Maintain Communications • Provide defined asks • Present naming rights opportunities



Avante Partnership Framework's Structured Customer Journey



Three Ways to Extract Value from an Early-Stage Ecosystem



Association

- **Showcase successful startups**, strengthening FoundersForge's brand as a hub for emerging founders.
- FoundersForge's **existing portfolio of 100+ ecosystem startups provides an immediate and tangible asset** for association-based value creation

Mentorship

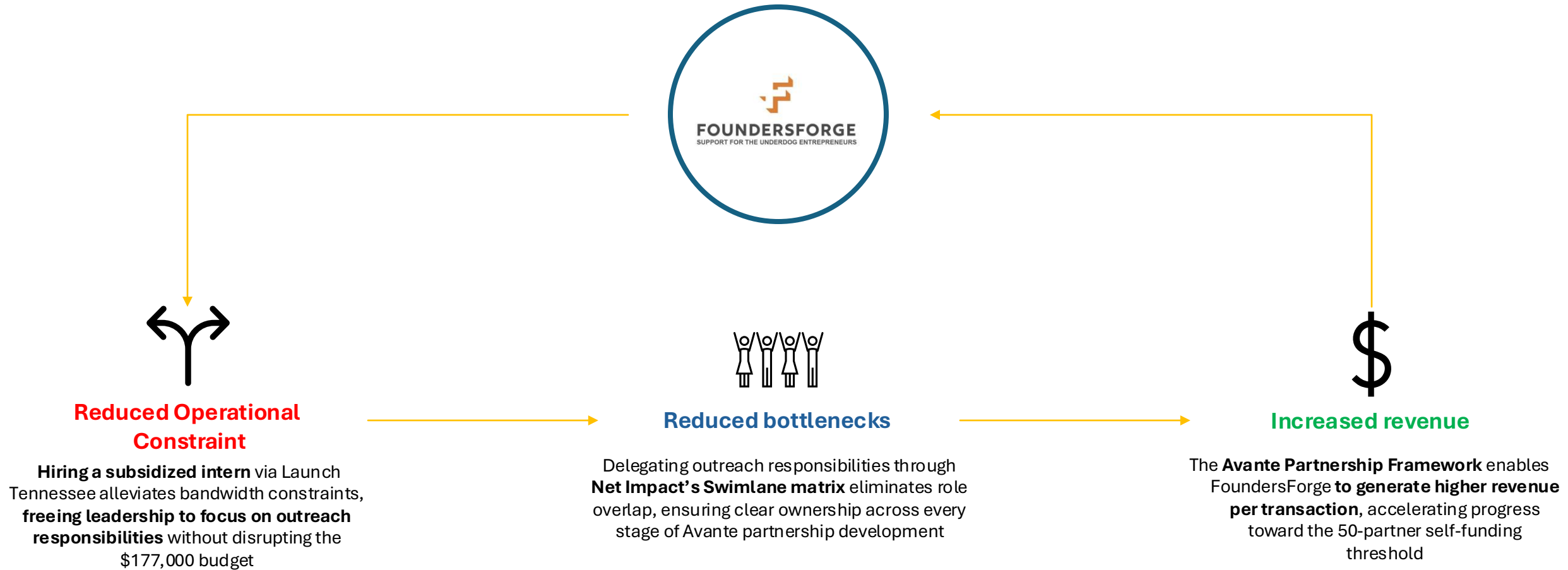
- **Engage founders as program contributors** to deepen their involvement.
- Ecosystem alumni, such as Green Lama, have proactively expressed willingness to contribute through mentorship, speaking, and program facilitation as their businesses scale

Sponsorship

- **Leverage the startup ecosystem to attract corporate sponsors** by offering structured access to founders, pitch events, and Avante cohorts.
- The **Avante Partnership Framework** is structured and ready for immediate deployment



Recommendations Deliver Measurable Impact Across Operations, Efficiency, and Revenue



Meet the Team

Lakshya Bordia
Project Lead



Class of 2028
Supply Chain Management/
Economics

Grace Wu
Project Analyst



Class of 2029
Finance/
Business Analytics &
Information Technology

Toby Hsuan
Project Analyst



Class of 2028
Supply Chain Management

Aditi Menon
Project Analyst



Class of 2029
Computer Science/
Cognitive Science

